



LG M-Disc

LG launches the Millennia Disc – a storage device with the durability of a millenium. Priced at ₹2000/-



GTB-8A

Blaupunkt launches all-in-one subwoofer for enhanced car-audio experience. It's priced at ₹9,990/-

Bazaar

Apple iPhone 5s

A phone for the future, held back by the present

The iPhone 5s is the perfect example of a bit of the new, with a dollop of the old. If you were a fan of the iPhone 5's aluminum chassis and chamfered edges, you will feel a warm sense of familiarity here. The colour options have been tweaked - space grey, silver and the attention grabbing gold. However, the bad part about carrying forward the same materials is that the 5s will possibly retain the same susceptibility to scratches and nicks, even though Apple says that the newer, more metallic colours will make the 5s additionally resilient to the aforementioned evils.

The form factor, the dimensions and the weight remain exactly the same as the predecessor - 123.8x58.6x7.6 mm and 112 grams. If you aren't looking very closely, or using the Golden iPhone 5s, most people may not even notice the difference. Unless someone can point out the dual LED flash at the back, or the redesigned home button which now hosts the fingerprint scanner.

Yes, biometrics have been done before in smartphones, but that hasn't gone too well. The fingerprint sensor, Touch ID is integrated into the home button itself and is protected with a sapphire crystal layer. The silver ring encircling the home button is the only visual give-away that this isn't the iPhone 5's home button! The sensor communicates directly with the registered fingerprint on the A7 chip, and that is locked away so that apps that don't have authorization do not have access to it. This is also stored on that particular iPhone, so there is no chance of it ending up on iCloud.

You can set up to five fingers, which can be used with Touch ID. If there are multiple people using the same phone, this is a rather convenient aspect. However, I did notice that the scan time did increase marginally if you have more than one print registered. It's important to note that the passcode still remains in the mix and provides an alternate means to unlock your phone.

The big change, possibly the biggest, comes with the new power package. You have the 64-bit dual core processor, teaming up with the M7 motion co-processor and a beefed up GPU. There aren't many third party apps that can take advantage of the 64-bit architecture, but that just means two things - the iPhone 5s' power package is designed to be future proof and app developers will sort themselves out and provide capable apps soon enough. The same goes for the M7 motion processor. M7, on

its part, collects data from the accelerometer, gyroscope, compass, etc., and can change app behavior depending on those readings. All those fitness apps, can easily utilize this processor while ignoring the main CPU and thus increasing battery life.

All this does make a significant difference, and yet at times, doesn't. Speaking as someone who is an iPhone 5 user, in most use cases you will not notice any performance difference. Most apps open at the same speed. This is exactly what I meant when I said that despite the significantly improved 64-bit processor, the iPhone 5s will remain just an incremental update. It's definitely a more powerful product, but there's not much that's making use of that power yet.

For the better processor, Apple has loaded the iPhone 5s with a slightly larger battery - 1560mAh to the iPhone 5's 1440mAh. We noticed what we feel to be about an hour more of battery life based on our daily usage, allowing us to get through an evening a bit more comfortably. If you have just Twitter and a couple of IMs running in the background, the iPhone 5s should easily get you through a day and a half.

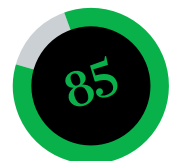
The iPhone 5S comes with a redesigned iSight camera, with the rear sporting an 8 megapixel shooter. Interestingly, Apple has increased the sensor size, bringing the effective pixel pitch to 1.4 microns. This means that the new 8 megapixel camera is capable of photos that are better in low light, have better dynamic range and nicer colours compared to its predecessor.

The new iPhone gets the processor upgrade, as well as a dedicated motion co-processor. The camera not only has a lot more features, but is a marked improvement over the fairly competent iPhone 5, which it succeeds. Touch ID feels at home straightaway. However, till the time your apps get updated to take care of the 64-bit architecture or the motion co-processor or the fingerprint sensor, the 5s feels like an incremental update. But, the future proofing is undeniable, and apps will soon fall in line.



Price
₹53,500

ZOOP



Features.....	95
Performance.....	90
Build.....	85
Value.....	70

Specifications

Processor: 64-bit A7 Chip;
M7 coprocessor: Wi-Fi: 802.11 a/b/g/n; Bluetooth 4.0; 4" screen with Retina display; Screen resolution: 1136x640; PPI: 326; Camera: 8Mp; **1080p HD video recording @ 30FPS;**

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